

Seeklight to DC / DCTerms Field Mapping (Rev-1)

This document records the mapping between fields generated by Seeklight (from JSTOR) and the established Dublin Core (DC) and DCTerms metadata fields used in Grinnell College's digital collections.

Status

✅ **Initial mapping complete** — Field mappings have been documented and a sample mapped dataset has been created.

Mapped Metadata Dataset

A transformed dataset is available that demonstrates the application of these field mappings:

- **File:** `../sample-objects/mapped-metadata-Rev-1/seeklight_export_to_DCAP01-FROM-SCRIPT.csv`
- **Source:** Seeklight export file `New_LAMP_628302.csv` (6 sample objects)
- **Format:** Alma/DCAP01 format matching the structure of `alma_export_20260506_131357.csv`
- **Contents:** All Seeklight-generated metadata transformed into DC/DCTerms fields using the mappings documented below

This file serves as a reference implementation of the field mappings and can be used to:

- Compare Seeklight output with existing Alma metadata
- Validate the completeness and accuracy of the mappings
- Test metadata import workflows
- Identify fields that require manual review or enhancement

How to Use This Document

1. For each sample object, compare the Seeklight-generated metadata (in `../sample-objects/seeklight-metadata-Rev-1/`) with the existing DC metadata (in `../sample-objects/mapped-metadata-Rev-1/`).
2. Identify which Seeklight fields correspond to which DC / DCTerms fields.
3. Record the mapping in the table below, noting any transformation or notes needed.
4. Reference `seeklight_export_to_DCAP01-FROM-SCRIPT.csv` for examples of applied mappings.

Field Mapping Table

Based on comparison of Alma export (`alma_export_20260506_131357.csv`) and Seeklight export (`New_LAMP_628302.csv`):

Core Descriptive Fields

Seeklight Field	DC / DCTerms Field	Notes / Transformation Required
Title	dc:title	Direct mapping
Creator	dc:creator	Direct mapping; may include multiple creators separated by pipe ()
Description	dc:description	Primary description field; very detailed in Seeklight output
Description	dcterms:abstract	Seeklight descriptions often function as abstracts
Subject	dc:subject	Direct mapping; Seeklight uses pipe () separators
Keywords	dc:subject	Additional subject terms; can be combined with Subject field
Named Entities	dc:contributor	Could map to contributor when entities are people/organizations
Publisher	dcterms:publisher	Direct mapping
Language	dc:language	Direct mapping; uses language names (e.g., "English")

Date Fields

Seeklight Field	DC / DCTerms Field	Notes / Transformation Required
Date	dc:date	General date field; Seeklight uses formats like "1992-03-05", "2026-02", or "Early 20th century"
Date	dcterms:created	When date represents creation date
Date	dcterms:issued	When date represents publication date
Period	dcterms:temporal	Time period (e.g., "Early 20th century", "20th century", "21st century")

Format and Physical Description

Seeklight Field	DC / DCTerms Field	Notes / Transformation Required
Type	dc:type	General resource type (e.g., "Monograph", "Oral history transcript", "Postcard", "Invitation")
Resource Type	dcterms:type.dcterms:DCMIType	DCMI Type vocabulary (e.g., "Documents", "Images")
Format	dc:format	Combined field in Seeklight; may need parsing; includes medium, technique, material, measurements

Seeklight Field	DC / DCTerms Field	Notes / Transformation Required
Medium	dcterms:medium	Material carrier (e.g., "Digital text", "Color lithograph", "printed paper")
Technique	dcterms:medium	Production method (e.g., "typed", "Color lithography", "halftone printing and letterpress")
Material	dcterms:medium	Physical materials (e.g., "PDF file", "Paper", "ink on paper")
Measurements	dcterms:extent	Physical dimensions (e.g., "27 pages", "135 pages", "3.5 x 5.5 in", "Unknown")

Coverage and Location

Seeklight Field	DC / DCTerms Field	Notes / Transformation Required
Coverage	dc:coverage	Seeklight combines style, culture, period, location with pipe separators
Location	dcterms:spatial	Geographic location (e.g., "Grinnell, Iowa", "Cedar Rapids, Iowa, USA", "Cambridge, United Kingdom")
Location	dcterms:spatial.dcterms:Point	When coordinate data available in Alma export

Seeklight-Specific Fields (No Direct DC Equivalent)

Seeklight Field	DC / DCTerms Field	Notes / Transformation Required
Style	<i>(custom field)</i>	Artistic/literary style (e.g., "interview transcript", "expository", "Postcard", "commemorative print")
Culture	<i>(custom field)</i>	Cultural context (e.g., "American", "Global")
SSID	<i>(identifier)</i>	Seeklight system identifier
Filename	<i>(technical)</i>	Original filename from Seeklight processing
File Count	<i>(technical)</i>	Number of files processed
Media URL	dcterms:identifier.dcterms:URI	URL to Seeklight representation

Alma-Specific Fields (Not in Seeklight)

Seeklight Field	DC / DCTerms Field	Notes / Transformation Required
(none)	dc:identifier	Multiple identifiers in Alma (handle, grinnell PID, alma MMS ID)
(none)	dc:relation	Relationship to other resources
(none)	dcterms:isPartOf	Collection membership
(none)	dc:rights	Rights statements (Alma has detailed rights URLs)
(none)	dcterms:provenance	Provenance information
(none)	dcterms:bibliographicCitation	Citation information
(none)	dcterms:tableOfContents	Table of contents for compound objects
Volume	(not commonly used)	Volume number (in Seeklight but empty in sample)
Issue	(not commonly used)	Issue number (in Seeklight but empty in sample)

Key Observations

1. **Seeklight provides rich contextual metadata:** Style, Culture, Period fields add interpretive context not typically in DC
2. **Descriptions are extensive:** Seeklight's Description field is very detailed and analytical
3. **Coverage field structure:** Seeklight uses a pipe-delimited structure combining style, culture, period, and location
4. **Format field complexity:** Seeklight combines medium, technique, material, and measurements in structured format
5. **Named entities extraction:** Seeklight identifies people, places, organizations - can supplement subject/contributor fields
6. **Date flexibility:** Seeklight handles various date formats and approximate dates well
7. **Missing from Seeklight:** Rights statements, persistent identifiers (handles), collection relationships, provenance

Sample Objects in Rev-1 Dataset

The Rev-1 dataset includes the following objects:

- Oral History Interview with Dorothy Lannom (SSID: 42356816)
- Washington High School, Cedar Rapids, Iowa (SSID: 42356815)
- Developmental Dilemmas: The Role of Power and Agency (SSID: 42356814)
- Seventy-Fifth Anniversary Invitation for Stewart Library (SSID: 42356813)
- Letter from mother to Staff Sgt James J. Ley, returned unclaimed (SSID: 42356812)
- Spaulding Model H Touring Car Advertisement (SSID: 42356811)

References

- [Dublin Core Metadata Element Set](#)
- [DCMI Metadata Terms](#)

- [JSTOR Seeklight](#)